Answers and talk notes

Math is Exploring and Thinking

What your student is learning

Tonight we make sense of a problem, plan a strategy, and use a fraction of a whole number to compare two amounts.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **A.** 5. Half of 10 means 10 split into 2 equal groups, so 10 ÷ 2 = 5.
2. **C.** 4. Split 12 into 3 equal groups: 12 ÷ 3 = 4.
3. **B.** Divide 20 by 4. Divide 20 by 4 first to find one equal part. Then multiply by 3 to take 3 parts.
4. **D.** 20. 30 ÷ 3 = 10 is one third. Two thirds is 2 × 10 = 20.
5. **B.** 12. 20 ÷ 5 = 4 is one fifth. Three fifths is 3 × 4 = 12 crayons.
6. **A.** 14. 35 ÷ 5 = 7 is one fifth. Two fifths is 2 × 7 = 14 students.

Talk about it

Can two thirds of the pods be more than all of the pods?

Home mission

A different situation: set out 12 beans, coins, or pasta pieces. Ask your student to make 3 equal piles. Then ask for 2/3 of the beans. How many is that?

When they are stuck, ask

- How many equal groups does the bottom number ask for?
- What is one of those groups worth?
- Does your answer make sense compared to the whole?

Try not to say

- Just multiply the two numbers together.
- Skip the check — the answer is fine.
- Fractions are too hard, use a calculator.